



36 All About
Photo Printers



42 30 Days With
Apple iPod



48 [DeXter]'s
Laboratory

Digital Passion

Fuelling the pursuit of technology knowledge

Meera Vankipuram

Deepak Pawar's modest workplace in Mumbai is like any event management office—replete with executives scampering to get the work done to perfection, telephones buzzing incessantly, logistics coordinators talking with their clients, and visitors entering and leaving the premises with elegant alacrity.

The office also has a peculiarity that most workplaces don't. It smells of obsession—Pawar's passion for all things on the bleeding edge of technology.

Pawar, managing director of Midas Events, craves for gizmos just as Sachin Tendulkar craves for Pepsi—*yeh dil maange more*. His O2 Xphone, for instance: If technology were fashion, then O2 is its Tyra Banks—sexy, hard-

working and intelligent. This smart phone with PDA functionality, is pricey—at around Rs 20,000 in the grey market.

"I like to own stuff that no one else in India has managed to get their hands on," says the 35-year-old Pawar. "My motto is, if someone else has it, I don't want it."

His subsidiary gizmo list: A Compaq iPAQ 4850 pocket PC, a Nokia 7610 camera phone, a digital guitar, a 30 GB Apple iPod with the iTrip FM transmitter, and a Bluetooth and WiFi-enabled IBM ThinkPad T41 notebook.

A cool laptop is also something that Rohit Gupta has—a Dell Inspiron 8500. In India, where buying a laptop is still mostly determined by the company you work for, Gupta decided to invest in one of his own. It's certainly not at the top of the notebook charts, but at \$2,780 (approx Rs 1.3 lakh) it's certainly

one of the most desired. With a configuration that goes something like this: Pentium 4 2.4 GHz mobile processor, 512 MB DDR RAM, 60 GB hard disk, 15.4-inch wide screen with WSXGA resolution, a combo-drive, a 64 MB

nVidia GeForce4 4200 Go graphics card—who wouldn't.

Gupta, scion of the multi-crore Gupta Group, a mid-level conglomerate that has interests in finance and trade, says he is going to attack the Nokia 6230 next. And a digital video camera after that.

Pawar, on the other hand, wants a smart robot next; something that could take calls, and perhaps even check email regularly and report to him. "I had the Sony AIBO (the robotic dog that made news a couple of years ago), but I gave it away because it was just

Main Story

Welcome to Gizmoland

Premium Nokia handsets, Tungsten T3s, Apple iPods, high-end IBM notebooks – just some of the gizmos that India's tech elite is buying. Meet the men behind the gadgets

Photograph: Jiten Gandhi

